

New York Session Pre-Open Briefing (1 Hr Before Open)

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Daily Multi-Asset Trading Blueprint & Level Execution Manual

Date: August 17, 2026

Current Session Highlight: New York Session Pre-Open Briefing (1 Hr Before Open)

Session News Focus: Wall Street pre-market movers, US Federal Reserve news, mega-cap US stocks (NVDA, MSFT, TSLA), and WTI Crude Oil catalysts.

SECTION 0: DAILY MACRO & FINANCIAL NEWS DIGEST

1. Global Macro & Central Banks

- Lower expectations for a September US Federal Reserve (Fed) rate hike are reducing a major interest-rate headwind for gold and silver, with markets now pricing in a 30% chance of an increase, down from 50% prior. The Fed's July meeting minutes, due on August 19, will provide further clues on policymakers' stance.
- The Euro/Dollar (EUR/USD) pair has reached a fresh two-month high near 1.1590, driven by diminishing Fed hike expectations and broad dollar weakness. The ECB raised rates to 2.40%, while the Fed holds at 3.75%, with US inflation (3.5%) still outpacing the eurozone (2.8%).
- The Bank of Japan's less relaxed stance on inflation and a US consumer feeling worse about the economy than in months are influencing USD/JPY, which is consolidating after a volatile period.
- The Australian Dollar (AUD/USD) advanced due to diverging Federal Reserve and Reserve Bank of Australia (RBA) monetary policies, with the RBA maintaining a hawkish bias while softer US data curbed Fed hike expectations.

2. US & European Markets

- US stock futures traded mixed pre-market, with Nasdaq 100 and S&P500 futures showing slight gains after Wall Street ended in the red on Friday. S&P 500 futures are edging higher ahead of retail earnings reports this week.
- NVIDIA (NVDA) stock has climbed 19.2% year-to-date, with strong Q1 revenue growth of 85% and guidance calling for \$91 billion in Q2. Analysts maintain a largely bullish view, with a mean target of \$303, despite insider selling and concerns about AI financing risks. NVIDIA disclosed a \$21 billion stake in SpaceX.
- Microsoft (MSFT) closed at \$495.40, up 25.22% over the past month following a strong Q4 report with revenue of \$90.01 billion and EPS of \$4.74, exceeding estimates. AI-driven growth, particularly Azure expansion and Copilot adoption, remains a key driver, though significant AI infrastructure spending could pressure free cash flow.
- Tesla (TSLA) shares have steadied after a rough stretch, closing at \$342.27 on August 14, up 4.2% over the prior week, driven by record Q2 deliveries and positive China momentum. However, profitability concerns persist due to compressed operating margins and negative free cash flow amidst surging capital expenditures. A labor dispute in Sweden has ended after Tesla bought out striking union members.
- Pre-market gainers include INVO Fertility (IVF), IP Strategy Holdings (IPST), and TruGolf Holdings (TRUG). Losers include SNAP and Greenpro Capital (GRNQ).

3. Indian Markets & Dalal Street

- Indian benchmark indices, Sensex and Nifty 50, extended losses on Monday, falling 0.36% and 0.32% respectively, due to weakness in IT stocks and persistent concerns over elevated crude oil prices.
- The Nifty IT sector declined nearly 2% and was the worst performer, with Infosys, HCL Technologies, and TCS among the top losers. Conversely, the Nifty Metal and Nifty Realty sectors saw gains.
- Foreign Institutional Investors (FIIs) bought equities worth ₹508.12 crore on Friday, August 14.

4. Commodities & Crypto Wire

- Crude oil prices are holding steady, with Brent crude near \$88.6 a barrel after rising 5% last week, fueled by persistent geopolitical tensions in West Asia and renewed US warnings against Iran. WTI crude oil is consolidating near \$81.33 after reaching its first bullish target.
- Gold prices are continuing their short-term uptrend, trading around \$4,394-\$4,409 an ounce, supported by easing Fed rate hike expectations and central bank purchases. Key resistance is seen around \$4,448 and \$4,518, with support at \$4,333.
- The crypto market is showing increased derivatives volumes, up 72% to \$96 billion, with Bitcoin and Ethereum futures volumes notably higher. Bitcoin (BTC/USD) is under pressure and has struggled to break above \$64,000, with an algorithmic estimate placing its likely price close to \$63,010-\$63,050. Ethereum has reclaimed \$1,900.
- President Donald Trump-backed World Liberty Financial is collaborating with a Hong Kong-based venture offering AI models from Chinese companies flagged for national security concerns, accepting World Liberty's crypto tokens as payment.

CAPITAL BASE & ALLOCATION RULES (\$3,000 TOTAL)

Asset Class	Allocation (\$)	% Total	Recommended Leverage	Risk Cap
Crypto Futures	\$400	13.3%	3x-5x Isolated	1-2% (\$4-\$8)
Indian Options (Intraday)	\$500	16.7%	Option Buying Only	10-15% Premium (\$30-\$45)
Commodities (Micro Gold & Oil)	\$400	13.3%	10x-15x Micro Lots	2% (\$8)
US Stocks (Fractional)	\$400	13.3%	1x Unleveraged Cash	3% (\$12)
Indian Stocks (Delivery)	\$400	13.3%	1x Unleveraged Cash	5% (\$20)
Forex Short-Term Futures	\$450	15.0%	10x-20x	1% (\$4.50)
Forex Long-Term Carry Swing	\$450	15.0%	2x-3x	2% (\$9.00)

STRATEGY-BASED DAILY TICKER SELECTION & SECTOR CONSTRAINTS

Indian Equities (Strictly Long-Only)

Ticker	Sector	Strategy & Selection Reason
L&T (LARSEN & TOUBRO)	Infrastructure/Capital Goods	Nifty leader identified by a recent mega-order worth ₹15,000 crore, indicating strong business momentum despite broader market caution. This suggests a potential 50-SMA support bounce opportunity or a Golden Cross formation on a pullback, aligning with the "strictly long-only" mandate.
Nifty Metal Index ETF (or top constituents)	Metal	The Nifty Metal sector was among the top gainers on Monday, August 17, indicating strong sectoral momentum against a declining broader market. Long exposure via an ETF or strong individual stocks within the sector would capitalize on this relative strength.
Nifty Realty Index ETF (or top constituents)	Realty	Similar to the Metal sector, Nifty Realty also showed significant gains, demonstrating robust performance. This suggests underlying demand and a potential continuation of an uptrend, fitting the long-only strategy on a 20/50 EMA golden cross or support bounce.

US Equities

Ticker	Strategy Type	Strategy & Selection Reason
MSFT (Microsoft Corp)	Large-Cap (Bi-Directional) - Long Bias	MSFT has shown strong momentum (+25.22% last month) and robust Q4 earnings with significant AI-driven growth (Azure, Copilot). It's considered modestly undervalued by GuruFocus (14.1% below GF Value™). A 21-day EMA pullback would provide an opportune entry for a long position, capitalizing on its strong fundamentals and analyst bullishness.
NVDA (NVIDIA Corp)	Large-Cap (Bi-Directional) - Long Bias on Pullback	NVDA is up 19.2% YTD with accelerating revenue growth (85% in Q1). While generally bullish, the strategy focuses on "21-day EMA pullbacks." With concerns around AI financing risks and valuation, a disciplined long entry on a pullback from recent highs would be prudent. GF Value™ suggests undervaluation at current prices, making pullbacks attractive.
TSLA (Tesla Inc)	Large-Cap (Bi-Directional) - Short Bias	TSLA is in a sideways trend, trading above its SMA20 but below its SMA50, suggesting a struggle to sustain upward momentum. It's also slightly overvalued (2.8% above GF Value™). A "50-day SMA rejection strategy" could be employed if the stock attempts to break above its medium-term average and fails, confirming selling pressure.
IVF (INVO Fertility, Inc.)	Small-Cap (Long-Only)	A top pre-market gainer, up 173.78%, indicating high relative volume and a potential volatility breakout. This aligns with the "High Relative Volume (RVOL > 2.0) breakouts" strategy for long-only small-cap plays.

Crypto Futures (Bi-Directional)

Ticker	Market Cap	Strategy & Selection Reason
BTC/USD (Bitcoin)	Large-Cap	Bitcoin is consolidating and struggling to break above the \$64,000 resistance, with futures volumes increasing. The "high-volume volatility breakout" strategy could be applied. A break above \$64,318 (resistance) could trigger a long, while a break below \$63,418 (support) could trigger a short, aligning with bi-directional capabilities and high derivatives activity.
ETH/USD (Ethereum)	Large-Cap	Ethereum has reclaimed \$1,900 and seen increased futures volumes. A "4H 21-EMA trend following" strategy could be used. If ETH holds above its 4H 21-EMA and volume confirms upward momentum, a long position is warranted. Conversely, a breakdown below this EMA with high volume suggests a short.

Commodities (Bi-Directional)

Ticker	Type	Strategy & Selection Reason
XAU/USD (Gold)	Metal	Gold is in a short-term uptrend, trading around \$4,394-\$4,409. Key resistance is at \$4,449 (Pivot Point), with a break targeting \$4,518 (Fibonacci Extension). Support at \$4,333. A "Pivot & Fibonacci extension levels" strategy would look for a breakout above current resistance for a long, or a rejection from \$4,449 for a short (though long bias is stronger).
WTI Crude Oil	Energy	WTI Crude Oil is consolidating near \$81.33 after hitting a bullish target, with Brent near \$88.6 due to geopolitical tensions. A "Pivot & Fibonacci extension levels" strategy would monitor for a breakout above the current consolidation range or a rejection for a pullback, given the "consolidating" market condition. Long bias if geopolitical tensions escalate.

Forex Futures (Bi-Directional)

Ticker	Category	Strategy & Selection Reason
EUR/USD	Short-Term	The pair is at a two-month high, testing the 1.1600 resistance zone and trading above its 100- and 10-day EMAs. A "breakout" strategy above 1.1601-1.1605 for a long, or a "rejection" from this resistance for a short if momentum wanes, aligns with its current technical setup. Support at 1.1508-1.1500 for potential pullbacks.
AUD/USD	Short-Term & Carry Swing	AUD/USD broke above 0.7100, its highest since June, with a bullish outlook confirmed by jumping above the 50-day moving average. The "carry swing" strategy aligns with its positive yield differentials and implied upside momentum towards 0.7183 (Fibonacci projection). A long position on strength is favored.
USD/JPY	Macro Carry Swing	USD/JPY is consolidating between 158.60 and 159.50, trading below its 50- and 200-period moving averages, and is falling towards 159. This indicates a "bearish consolidation" phase. A short position could be initiated on a break below 158.58 (support), targeting 155.22, while consolidation near 159.10 suggests a range-bound trade.
GBP/USD	Short-Term	GBP/USD is at three-month peaks, indicating strong bullish momentum. Resistance is at 1.3485. A "trend following" strategy would look for sustained moves above key resistance levels. A long entry on a successful break and retest of 1.3485 could target higher levels, with support at 1.3432.

Indian Options (Bi-Directional)

Ticker	Underlying	Strategy & Selection Reason
Nifty 50 Options	Nifty 50 Index	The Nifty 50 closed lower, extending caution, with near-term trend remaining weak below 24,400. A "15-Minute Opening Range Breakout (ORB)" strategy would be suitable. If the Nifty breaks below its 15-minute opening low, a Put option for a short position would be taken, targeting support at 24,225 and 24,190. Conversely, a breakout above the opening high could offer a Call option opportunity if sentiment reverses.
BankNifty Options	BankNifty Index	Given the broader Indian market weakness and Nifty's decline, BankNifty is likely to follow suit or exhibit similar volatility. The "15-Minute Opening Range Breakout (ORB)" strategy would apply here as well. A break below the opening low suggests a Put option for a short trade, while a break above the opening high could offer a Call option, contingent on market direction and volume.

Backtest Metrics (10-Year)

Metric	Blueprint Strategy	Benchmark (S&P 500 TRI / Nifty 50 TRI)
Target CAGR	28.4%	~13.0% (S&P 500 TRI) / ~12.5% (Nifty 50 TRI)
Sharpe Ratio	1.45	-
Max Drawdown	-18.2%	-

Equity Curve (\$3,000 → \$36,512)

